



Attracting New Business

Gaining new customers or clients can help your start-up grow. Conventional marketing may be costly, but you can achieve good results with smart ideas.

Analyzing your customers

It is vital to focus your efforts on the customers who are more likely to give you repeat business and spend more on each purchase (see pp.152–153). Regularly examine your sales data, use free tools such as Google Analytics (see pp.212–215), and gather information on growth in your market to identify any changes in your customer base. Although your business may have appealed to a certain type of customer at first, you need to know whether that has changed, why those changes may

have occurred, and which group is most valuable to your business. By always knowing who your potential customers are, and understanding their buying habits, you can target them.

Becoming more visible

Boost your presence in the places where your customers like to shop, whether virtually or face to face. Run a paid social-media marketing campaign containing compelling or educational content, or an offer—starting small and analyzing the response rate—and list your location on all popular and free online business directories and maps.

WORKING WITH INFLUENCERS

An influencer is an individual with a large social media following, sometimes with millions subscribing to their channels. They “influence” followers by posting paid-for content promoting a brand’s product or service.

Partnering with influencers can be a valuable tool, enabling you to advertise your business to a particular target audience—the influencer’s followers. For example, if you sell fitness equipment, you could sponsor an influencer known to be an exercise fanatic, whose followers would likely be interested in fitness and find your product appealing.

Ways to increase your customer appeal

Many of the methods for bringing new customers to your business will cost very little, other than your time. Brainstorm with staff, friends, and family to generate and improve ideas. Research what other successful businesses have done. Make the most of staff who understand and engage with social media, and sustain a genuine interest in your industry and customer communities.

Offer promotions and discounts

For first-time buyers, offer discounts, free express delivery, a gift, or other incentive. Get the word out on paid-for social media, through your website, or with local flyers and marketing.

Reconnect with past customers

Give lapsed buyers an incentive to return by emailing a “we miss you” offer, with a discount or free gift on their next purchase.

